

1. sqlite-utils 4.0rc1 adds migrations and nested transactions

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-21T23:35:47+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/21/sqlite-utils-40rc1/#atom-everything>

sqlite-utils is my combined Python library and CLI tool for working with SQLite databases. It provides an extensive set of higher-level operations on top of Python's default sqlite3 package, including support for complex table transformations, automatic table creation from JSON data and a whole lot more. I released sqlite-utils 4.0rc1, the first release candidate for sqlite-utils v4. The major version bump indicates some (minor) backwards incompatible changes, so I'm interested in having people try this out before I commit to a stable release. New feature: migrations There are two significant new features in this RC compared to the previous 4.0 alphas. The first is support for database migrations. This isn't a completely new implementation - it's a slightly modified port of the sqlite-migrate package I released a few years ago. I think that package has proved itself over time, so I'm now ready to bundle it with sqlite-utils directly. Here's what a set of migrations in a migrations.py file looks like:

```
from sqlite_utils import Database, Migrations
migrations = Migrations("creatures") @ migrations
def create_table(db): db["creatures"].create({"id": int, "name":...
```

2. sqlite-utils 4.0rc1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-21T23:30:04+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/21/sqlite-utils/#atom-everything>

Release: sqlite-utils 4.0rc1 See [sqlite-utils 4.0rc1 adds migrations and nested transactions](#).

Tags: sqlite-utils

3. Temporary Cloudflare Accounts for AI agents

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-21T22:01:04+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/21/temporary-cloudflare-accounts/#atom-everything>

Temporary Cloudflare Accounts for AI agents The announcement says this is "for AI agents" but (as is pretty common these days) the AI hook isn't really necessary, this is an interesting feature for everyone else as well. Short version: you can now create a Cloudflare Workers project and run this, without even creating a Cloudflare account: `npx wrangler deploy --temporary` Cloudflare will deploy the application to a new, ephemeral project which will stay live for 60 minutes. I had GPT-5.5 xhigh in Codex Desktop build this test application providing a tool for following HTTP redirects and returning the final destination. The temporary deployment worked as advertised. Running the deployment spits out the URL to a page for claiming the new project, for if you want it to last for more than 60 minutes. Here's what that claim screen looks like: [Via Hacker News](#) Tags: cloudflare

4. Before and After: MacOS 27 Golden Gate Beta 1's App Icons

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-21T22:39:19Z

Link: <https://basicappleguy.com/basicappleblog/macOS-golden-gate-icon-comparison>

Basic Apple Guy, back during WWDC: WWDC always brings a torrent of new content, details, and platform-wide changes. One of the first things I noticed after installing the macOS Golden Gate beta was the updated icon design. The colours are much bolder, several icons have been adjusted, and the refraction in the Liquid Glass effect has changed significantly, especially in icons like Journal. There's also a noticeable sharpness to the icons, along with a flattening of the Liquid Glass effect. I'm not sure yet whether this is simply an early-beta artifact or the intended final look. I think it's definitely the intended look, and I like it. The changes in these app icons are all subtle, but they're all changes for the better. I still don't like the primitive flat shapes and mandated squircle, but at least the trend is finally moving in the right direction again. ?

5. Mux ? Video for Developers

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-21T21:35:48Z

Link: https://www.mux.com/?utm_campaign=fireball&utm_source=DF

My thanks to Mux for sponsoring Daring Fireball last week. Video is a boatload of data. Every video file in your product contains audio, objects, and scenes that most stacks can't read or access. Mux Robots turns that data into video intelligence. Configure your video workflows once, and they run automatically on every new upload: ask questions, summarize, find key moments, and more. No asset webhooks or self-hosted glue code needed. Mux is video infrastructure for developers, trusted by Synthesia, Shopify, and the U.S. Soccer Federation. Start building for free. Use code FIREBALL at signup for an extra \$50 credit. ?

6. Domino's Admitted Their Pizza Tasted Like Cardboard

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-19T15:59:10Z

Link: <https://www.inc.com/jeff-haden/10-years-ago-cardboard-pizza-almost-killed-dominos-then-dominos-did-something-brilliant.html>

Re: my post on Verizon flat-out admitting their business practices have resembled a scheme from Dr. Evil, Domino's did something similar regarding their pizza a while back. This 2021 story for Inc. by Jeff Haden describes the turnaround. ?

7. Queens on a prime order board

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 22 Jun 2026 00:21:44 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/21/queens-prime/>

The n queens problem is to place on an $n \times n$ chessboard n queens so that none attacks any other. This means there is only one queen on every horizontal, vertical, and diagonal line. When n is a prime number $\neq 5$, it is sufficient to place the queens on a line that has slope 2, 3, 4, ..., $[n]$ The post Queens on a prime order board first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. PyPy and Python 3 for us

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-06-21T03:14:09Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/python/PyPyAndPython3ForUs>

Ever since I started using PyPy and then had it quietly work fine for years , I've been keeping it in mind as a generally easy way to speed up any Python program that could benefit from a performance boost (which programs PyPy could accelerate sometimes surprised me). But that was in the era when most everything we had was Python 2 based. Now that I'm moving more and more things to Python 3, there's a little issue opening up that I've been thinking about. That issue is what versions of (C)Python PyPy supports, which is to say which language version it implements. If you look at the PyPy site , you'll see that of Python 3 versions they support, the most recent one is 3.11, which the regular ('CPython') version of was released in late 2022. If you've followed a bit of PyPy development news, you may have read that the PyPy project is resource constrained and thus lags behind CPython for things like implementing language features or standard library changes. My understanding is that PyPy's timeline for implementing language features beyond 3.11 is "whenever we can but don't hold your breath". On the one hand, Python 3.11 is a perfectly okay version of Python. On the other hand, Pytho...

9. On Vulgar Materialism

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Sun, 21 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/on-vulgar-materialism>

Or, sufficiently advanced cynicism is indistinguishable from naïveté.

10. The doom justifies the valuation

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-06-21T00:00:00-07:00

Link:

<https://geohot.github.io//blog/jekyll/update/2026/06/21/the-doom-justifies-the-valuation.html>

I've been in Berkeley for the last 2 weeks. I haven't really been back here for a while, and it's worse than you can believe. This is a cult of atheistic hedonists needing AI doom to be true to justify their life choices. Or acceleration. Or something . They need to make impact .

I mean, narcissism of small differences to an extent, but I stopped long before these people did. If San Francisco was nuked tomorrow, the world would feel a weight off their shoulders. ?? This isn't technology, this is a mind virus. New York wants a couple basis points so they can maintain their lifestyle, Los Angeles wants a bit of your attention so they can feel famous, SF wants to come for your inner life and pimp you out and mediate every interaction and there's not even a so. Read the GLM-5.2 blog post . This is how I imagined AI progress being, and this is frontier stuff, the model is on par with Opus 4.8 and GPT-5.5. It's a pleasant technical look into how things are slowly improving. This is what comma blog posts look like also. This is the world of technology I love. Now look at the Anthropic blog. It looks totally different. From this post : AI is advancing at exponential speed, and the policym...